PAVEL CHERKASHIN

Deal Lead, Special Situations • New Business Incubation • Venture & Structured Finance • Operator

San Francisco, CA (Hybrid / On-site) | pavel@mindrock.capital | linkedin.com/in/pavelcherkashin | github.com/minutta

Executive Thesis: *"Scaling OpenAI's highest-upside frontier: taking ambiguous, first-of-their-kind commercial opportunities from blank-page thesis to scalable, high-margin business units. 20+ year track record combining frontier venture investor ($100M+ deployed, pioneer of venture notes and fintech syndicates), tech operator and corporate executive (Adobe, Microsoft; architected landmark 1.5M+ seat enterprise transaction), and AI systems builder. Focused on unlocking institutional financial services, structured deal vehicles, and autonomous AI-native business models where standard playbooks do not yet exist."*

STRATEGIC FOCUS: SPECIAL SITUATIONS MANDATE & NEW BUSINESS INCUBATION

The Special Situations mandate is OpenAI's commercial incubator for transformative ventures that exceed traditional enterprise SaaS boundaries. We take on ambiguous, high-upside market opportunities where product form factors, pricing structures, and delivery frameworks must be invented from scratch. Prioritizing Financial Services first: transforming venture capital, private equity, investment banking, and institutional asset management through autonomous agent workflows, synthetic due diligence, and programmatic deal settlement (venture notes, angel syndicates, secondary liquidity). I translate bleeding-edge AI models into defensible, revenue-generating commercial engines.

THE 6-MONTH SPECIAL SITUATIONS ACCELERATION ARC (THESIS TO LAUNCH)

Months 1–2 **Thesis & Pilot Vehicles**	**Financial Services Thesis & Pilot Deal Vehicles:** Formalize flagship commercial thesis for AI-augmented financial services and investment banking. Structure initial cohort of venture notes and angel syndicate vehicles with premier Silicon Valley funds. Align OpenAI Product, Research, Legal, and Forward Deployed Engineering (FDE) on novel data governance and non-standard contract parameters.
Months 3–4 **Landmark Structuring**	**Landmark Commercial Pacts & Structural Economics:** Originate, negotiate, and close 2 landmark multi-party strategic pacts with institutional financial partners. Pioneer novel value-sharing frameworks (compute-for-equity, performance-contingent royalties, and revenue-sharing licenses). Establish end-to-end operational blueprint for repeatable deal delivery.
Months 5–6 **Unit Scale & Automation**	**Business Unit Expansion & Autonomous Telemetry:** Scale validated financial services pilots into permanent, high-margin business units within OpenAI. Deploy autonomous agent pipelines for continuous deal sourcing, risk modeling, and post-signature telemetry. Replicate the Special Situations playbook across adjacent capital-intensive verticals (energy, sovereign AI).

CORE SPECIAL SITUATIONS & COMMERCIAL CAPABILITIES

- **0-to-1 Venture Incubation:** Proven track record translating novel technical concepts into validated commercial offerings, pricing frameworks, and scalable business lines.
- **Financial Services & Capital Markets:** Deep domain mastery across venture capital, private equity, fintech syndicates, securities compliance, and institutional capital.
- **Non-Standard Deal Structuring:** Expert architect of creative commercial vehicles, venture notes, shared-upside frameworks, and multi-party consortium agreements.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Seamless coordination across Research, Product, Engineering, Legal, and Finance to execute novel partnerships without operational friction.

SELECTED CAREER TRACK RECORD & STRATEGIC DEAL LEADERSHIP

Managing Partner & Fintech Ecosystem Architect — *Mindrock Capital / Vestor.In* (2016–Present)

- **$100M+ Capital Deployed:** Managed and deployed $100M+ into frontier AI, advanced computing, and deep-tech platforms. Structured innovative venture notes, fintech angel syndicates, and SPVs enabling cross-border institutional co-investments.
  - **Autonomous AI Systems:** Pioneered autonomous multi-agent networks automating quantitative investment telemetry, synthetic due diligence, and programmatic contract execution.

Regional Director & Enterprise Licensing Executive — *Adobe Systems / Enterprise Operations*

- **Historic 1.5M+ Seat Agreement:** Conceived, negotiated, and closed the **largest single enterprise/institutional transaction in Adobe's corporate history** (1.5M+ licenses). Designed custom multi-tier revenue-sharing frameworks, government procurement alignments, and commercial terms that served as a global company benchmark.

Technology Entrepreneur & Corporate Development — *Actis Systems / Microsoft Partner Network*

- Founded, scaled, and exited leading technology businesses. Structured complex cross-border joint ventures, technology licensing alliances, and commercial integration agreements across US, European, and Asian markets.

Venture Author & Global Mentor — *Founder Institute Alumnus (2014) & Academic Textbook Author*

- Authored authoritative university textbook on venture capital and enterprise creation. Mentored 5,000+ technology founders and operators; established direct pipelines bridging institutional capital with technical founders.

EDUCATION, QUANTITATIVE FOUNDATION & CREDENTIALS

- **Quantitative Foundation & Systems:** Applied Mathematics & Computer Science, Russian State University of Oil & Gas.
  - **Global Capital Network:** Founder Institute Silicon Valley Alumnus (2014); established relationships across US, European, and Asian VC and family offices.
  - **Executive Communication:** Fluent English, native Russian; veteran negotiator across diverse regulatory and legal frameworks.